



Pega Interview Romance Guide

*Because the hottest developers know their Case Types and their Decision
Tables*

For: 3+ Years Pega Developer · CSA / SSA Interview Ready

Hey gorgeous mind — someone who cares about your career wrote this for you.
Every page is a love letter to your future offer letter. Read me cover to cover. I
promise I won't let a single interview topic leave you hanging.

Prepared with admiration · Complete · No topic left behind

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Chapter 1: First Impressions — Pega Platform & Architecture

They say you never get a second chance at a first impression. Pega says: build it once on the platform, reuse it everywhere. Kind of like how I can't stop thinking about how prepared you're about to be.

What is Pega?

Pega is a **low-code BPM + CRM + Case Management platform** built on Java. It uses a **rules-driven, model-driven architecture** where business logic is externalized into declarative rules rather than hard-coded Java.

Core Architecture Layers

Layer	Purpose	Key Rules
Presentation	UI rendering	Section, Harness, Layout, Portal
Process / Case	Workflow orchestration	Case Type, Flow, Flow Action, Stage
Decision	Business logic branching	When, Decision Table, MapValue, Decision Tree
Data	Data access & transformation	Data Page, Data Transform, Report Definition
Integration	External system communication	Connect-REST, Service-REST, Connect-SQL
Security	Access control	Access Group, Role, Privilege

Q: What makes Pega different from traditional Java development?

Pega uses **model-driven development** with visual designers, automatic rule resolution, built-in case management, and guardrails. Changes propagate via inheritance without recompiling entire applications. Business users can participate via App Studio.

Q: What is the difference between App Studio and Dev Studio?

App Studio — persona-based, low-code, guided experience for business developers. **Dev Studio** — full technical IDE for senior developers: rule forms, tracer, PAL, advanced configuration.

Q: What is Pega Infinity?

Pega Infinity is the unified platform release (8.x+) combining BPM, CRM, AI, RPA, and Constellation UI. It emphasizes **center-out architecture**, omnichannel experiences, and AI-powered decisioning.

Interview whisper: Mention "center-out" — design data and logic once at the center, expose through any channel (web, mobile, API). Interviewers melt a little when you say it confidently.

Chapter 2: Meeting the Family — Class Hierarchy & Inheritance

Every great relationship has roots. In Pega, your class hierarchy is the family tree — and darling, you need to know who's related to whom before you introduce your rules to the world.

Class Types

- **Abstract class** — cannot create instances; exists for inheritance only (e.g., `Work-`)
- **Concrete class** — instances can be created (e.g., `Work-Cover-` , `Data-`)
- **Pattern inheritance** — inherits from parent in hierarchy (`@baseclass` → `Work-` → `Work-Cover-`)
- **Directed inheritance** — explicitly inherits from another class via `pyPatternInheritance` / directed parent

Class Categories

Prefix	Usage
Work-	Case instances, assignments, work objects
Data-	Data objects, lookup tables, system data
Rule-	All rule instances
Assign-	Assignment instances
History-	Audit/history records
Index-	Search index objects

Q: What is the difference between Pattern and Directed inheritance?

Pattern inheritance follows the class namespace hierarchy automatically. **Directed inheritance** lets a class inherit from a class outside its namespace tree — useful for reusing rules across applications without duplicating.

Q: What is a class group?

A **class group** (work pool) groups related case types under one database table. All case types in a class group share the same `pc_work` (or custom) table. Defined in the application rule.

Q: What is the difference between `Work-Cover-` and a regular work class?

`Work-Cover-` is the abstract parent for all work classes. Concrete case types extend it (e.g., `Work-Cover-LoanApp`). It provides standard work object properties: `pyStatusWork` , `pxCreateDateTime` , etc.

Chapter 3: The Art of Choosing — Rule Resolution

Rule Resolution is Pega's way of finding THE ONE rule out of thousands. It's picky, methodical, and deeply romantic — just like you deserve in an interview panel.

Rule Resolution Algorithm (10 Steps)

1. Start with **class** of the calling rule
2. Find rules matching **rule type + name**
3. Filter by **ruleset + version** (application stack)
4. Discard **not available** rules
5. Discard **blocked** rules
6. Rank by **class** (nearest class wins)
7. Rank by **ruleset version**
8. Consider **circumstance** (dated or templated)
9. Consider **ruleset version availability**
10. Return the **single winning rule** (or warn if duplicates)

Key Concepts

- **Ruleset** — versioned container of related rules (e.g., `MyApp:01-01-01`)
- **Application stack** — ordered list of ruleset versions the application uses
- **Circumstance** — time-based or property-based rule variant
- **Rule availability** — Available, Not Available, Blocked, Final, Withdrawn

Q: What happens when two rules have the same specificity?

Pega throws a **duplicate rule warning** during resolution. The rule with the higher ruleset version or more specific circumstance wins, but duplicates should be resolved — they indicate design problems.

Q: What is a circumstance template?

A circumstance template defines a **property-based condition** for rule variants (e.g., `.pyCountry = "US"`). Multiple rules share the template; the template property value determines which variant applies.

Q: Can you explain caching in rule resolution?

Pega caches resolved rules in the **rules cache** (FUA — Full Rule Assembly). First resolution is expensive; subsequent calls use cache. Cache invalidates on rule save, ruleset version change, or cache flush.

Guardrail: Never copy-paste rules across classes. Use inheritance. Interviewers love hearing you say "I'd extend, not duplicate."

Chapter 4: Love at First Case — Case Management

A case is a story — beginning, middle, resolution. Your job is to make every case feel seen. Interviewers want to know you can architect stories, not just click buttons.

Case Type Components

- **Case Type** — blueprint for a business process (e.g., Loan Application)
- **Case ID** — unique identifier (configured via Case ID rule)
- **Stages** — high-level lifecycle phases
- **Processes** — flows within stages
- **Data model** — properties captured during the case
- **Views / UI** — user interaction screens

Case Statuses

Status	Meaning
New	Just created, not yet started
Open	Active, in progress
Pending-...	Waiting (external event, approval, etc.)
Resolved-Completed	Successfully finished
Resolved-Cancelled	Cancelled/withdrawn

Q: What is the difference between a case and a work object?

In modern Pega they're synonymous. Historically "work object" referred to the `Work-` class instance. A **case** is the business-friendly term for a unit of work tracked through a lifecycle.

Q: What is a child case / subcase?

A **child case** is a separate case type instantiated from a parent case. It has its own lifecycle but can be linked. Use **Case Type rule** → **Processes** → **Add case** or `pxCreateCase` API.

Q: Explain case-wide actions vs stage-specific actions.

Case-wide actions are available in every stage (e.g., "Transfer"). **Stage-specific actions** appear only in their configured stage. Both are Flow Actions presented to users.

Q: What is the Wait shape in a flow?

The **Wait** shape pauses flow execution until an event occurs: timer expiry, case dependency resolution, or external signal. The assignment status becomes `Pending- . . . .`

Chapter 5: Stages of Us — Processes, Flows & Assignments

Every relationship has stages. Pega cases do too. Know when to advance, when to loop back, and when to route work to someone who can handle it — skills you clearly already have.

Flow Shapes You Must Know

Shape	Purpose
Assignment	Creates work item for user/system
Decision	Branches based on When rule or expression
Subprocess	Calls another flow
Utility	Runs automation without assignment
Wait	Pauses for event/timer
Split-Join	Parallel processing branches
Split-ForEach	Iterates over page list

Assignment Types

- **Worklist** — shared pool; any qualified user can pull
- **Workbasket** — team queue
- **Work queue** — routed to specific operator or team
- **Custom router** — activity or decision-based routing

Q: What is the difference between Flow Action and Flow?

Flow — backend process automation (shapes, connectors). **Flow Action** — user-facing action button (e.g., "Approve", "Submit") that may call a flow or update assignment. Flow Actions have sections for UI.

Q: What is a local flow action vs connector flow action?

Local — runs in context of current assignment without leaving harness. **Connector** — navigates to a different assignment/flow, typically changes screen.

Q: Explain pyDefault flow.

`pyDefault` is the primary flow executed when a case enters a stage/process. Every process has one default flow that orchestrates the steps.

Q: How does approval routing work?

Use **Approval shape** or configure cascading approvals via **WorkBasket/WorkQueue**. Smart shapes can use reporting or decision rules. For complex chains, use **pxApproval** or custom routing activity.

Chapter 6: What's on Your Mind — Clipboard & Data Model

The clipboard is where Pega keeps its thoughts about your case. Get intimate with it — interviewers always ask what's stored where.

Clipboard Pages

- **Primary page** — implicit page context for rules (usually `pyWorkPage`)
- **Top-level pages** — `pxRequestor` , `pxThread` , `OperatorID`
- **Parameter page** — `param` for passing arguments
- **Step page** — defined on flow shapes for scoped data

Property Types

Type	Description	Example
Text	Single string	<code>.FirstName</code>
Integer / Decimal	Numbers	<code>.Age</code>
DateTime	Timestamp	<code>.SubmittedDate</code>
Page	Embedded object	<code>.Customer</code>
Page List	Ordered collection	<code>.OrderItems()</code>
Page Group	Keyed collection	<code>.Documents()</code>

Q: What is the difference between Page List and Page Group?

Page List — ordered, indexed by integer (`( 1 )` , `( 2 )`). **Page Group** — unordered, indexed by string key (`( "home" )`). Use Page List for sequences, Page Group for named lookups.

Q: What are embedded pages vs linked pages?

Embedded — stored inside parent page (serialized with parent). **Linked** — reference to separate clipboard page via `pxLinkedRefTo` . Linked pages save memory but need management.

Q: Explain pyWorkPage, pxThread, pxRequestor.

`pyWorkPage` — current case data. `pxThread` — holds open assignments and case references for the session. `pxRequestor` — operator/session context (user info, roles, access group).

Chapter 7: Data Pages — Your Perfect Plus-One

Data Pages don't ghost you. They show up when you need them, cache responsibly, and never make you fetch the same data twice unless you ask. Relationship goals.

Data Page Types

- **Read-only** — lookup/reference data (most common)
- **Editable** — supports save plans for write-back
- **List** — returns multiple results (page list structure)
- **Singleton** — single object

Load Modes

Mode	Behavior
stale-while-revalidate (SWR)	Return cached, refresh in background
reload-once	Load once per requestor session
reload-if older than	Refresh after specified time
access-group	Shared across users in access group
requestor	Per-user cache
node	Shared across cluster node

Q: What is the difference between Report Definition and Data Page?

Report Definition — SQL-based query against DB, good for reporting/analytics. **Data Page** — abstraction layer with sources (Report Def, Activity, Connector, Lookup), supports caching, parameters, and responsive loading in UI.

Q: How do you parameterize a Data Page?

Define **parameters** on the Data Page rule. Pass values via `D_[Pagename][param1:value1]` syntax or from UI/data transform. Parameters affect cache key.

Q: What is a savable Data Page?

An **editable Data Page** with a **Save Plan** (Database/Activity/Flow) that persists changes back to source. Used in Constellation for inline editing of data types.

Modern answer: Prefer Data Pages over activities for data retrieval. Say it with confidence — it's a guardrail and interviewers nod.

Chapter 8: Data Transforms — Dressing Data to Impress

Data Transforms are the stylist of the Pega world — they take raw data and make it interview-ready. No drama, no loops (well, minimal), just clean mapping.

Common Actions

- **Set** — assign value to property
- **Update Page** — apply transform to embedded page
- **Append to** — add to page list
- **Remove** — delete page/list entry
- **When** — conditional step execution
- **Otherwise** — else branch
- **For Each Page In** — iterate page list

Q: Data Transform vs Activity — when to use which?

Data Transform — property mapping, simple logic, no loops over large datasets, preferred for maintainability.

Activity — complex iteration, calling multiple rules, integration orchestration, legacy code. Always prefer DT when possible.

Q: How do you call a Data Transform from another?

Use **Update Page** action or **Apply Data Transform** action, referencing the target transform name. Can pass pages as context.

Q: What is Auto-populate?

Auto-populate on a property automatically runs a Data Transform or Activity when the property is referenced, keeping derived data fresh.

Chapter 9: Activities — The Ex You Still Respect

Activities are the old flame of Pega — you don't chase them anymore, but you respect the history. Know them. Don't lead with them.

Activity Steps (Key Methods)

Method	Purpose
Property-Set	Set property value
Call	Invoke another activity
Apply-DataTransform	Run data transform
Obj-Open / Obj-Save	DB read/write
Page-New / Page-Remove	Clipboard page management
Connect-REST	Invoke REST connector
Queue-For-Agent	Defer processing to agent

Q: Why are activities being phased out?

Activities are **procedural**, hard to maintain, bypass guardrails, and allow infinite loops. Pega pushes **Data Transforms**, **Automations**, and **Flows** as declarative alternatives. Activities still needed for legacy and edge cases.

Q: What is Activity Security?

Activities can be restricted via **Activity Allow List** (allow list for called activities) and **Privilege** on the activity rule. Restricted activities cannot be called from UI or unapproved contexts.

Q: Explain Call vs Branch in activities.

Call — invokes sub-activity; returns after completion. **Branch** — conditional jump to labeled step within same activity.

Chapter 10: Decision Rules — When to Say Yes or No

Decision rules are your boundary-setters. They know exactly when to commit and when to walk away. Be that clear in your interview answers.

Decision Rule Types

Rule	Use Case
When	Single true/false condition
Decision Table	Multiple conditions → multiple outcomes (grid)
Decision Tree	Hierarchical if-else branching
MapValue	One input → one output lookup
Nested If	Nested conditional (legacy)
Scorecard	Weighted scoring model
Decision Strategy	AI-driven multi-channel decisioning (NBAM)

Q: Decision Table vs Decision Tree?

Table — best for combinatorial logic (multiple AND/OR conditions in grid). **Tree** — best for sequential/hierarchical decisions. Tables are easier to maintain for business users.

Q: What is a Scorecard?

A **Scorecard** assigns weighted scores to conditions. Total score maps to a result (e.g., credit risk rating). Used in strategies and flow decisions.

Q: How do you invoke a When rule?

In flows (Decision shape), Data Transforms (When action), Activities (`Property-Set` with `@{when:RuleName}`), Declare Expressions, and Validation rules.

Chapter 11: Declare Rules — Commitment Without Clinginess

Declare rules compute values automatically — no need to nag. They refresh when dependencies change. That's emotional maturity, and Pega has it.

Declare Rule Types

- **Declare Expression** — computed property value (e.g., `.FullName = .FirstName + " " + .LastName`)
- **Declare Constraint** — validation enforced on property change
- **Declare OnChange** — triggers activity/DT when property changes
- **Declare Trigger** — fires on save of data class instance
- **Declare Index** — maintains searchable index

Q: How do Declare Expressions work?

They define **target properties** computed from **source properties**. Pega tracks dependencies and recalculates automatically when sources change — forward chaining.

Q: Declare OnChange vs Trigger?

OnChange — reacts to property value change on clipboard (any class). **Trigger** — fires on **commit/save** of persistent object (Data- class instances).

Chapter 12: UI Seduction — Sections, Harnesses & Constellation

Your UI should make users stay. Constellation is the glow-up. Know both traditional and modern — you're a catch either way.

Traditional UI Stack

- **Section** — reusable UI fragment (fields, layouts)
- **Harness** — container composing sections (Perform, Review, Confirm)
- **Flow Action** — links harness to process action
- **Portal** — application shell (Case Worker, Case Manager)
- **Skin** — look and feel (cosmetic)

Constellation / Cosmos

- **View** — JSON-driven UI (replaces Section in Constellation)
- **Full Page** — complete screen
- **Widget** — reusable UI component
- **Theme** — design tokens, styling
- Uses **React** rendering engine, channel-agnostic

Q: Section vs Harness?

Section — building block with fields/layouts. **Harness** — assembles sections into a complete screen for a specific purpose (new harness, perform harness, etc.).

Q: What is Constellation and why did Pega introduce it?

Constellation is Pega's **model-driven UI architecture** using Cosmos React. Benefits: responsive design, omnichannel (web/mobile), faster development via views, no heavy harness customization, better performance.

Q: What is dynamic layout vs column layout?

Dynamic layout — flex-based, responsive, modern (preferred). **Column/Freeform** — legacy table-based positioning. Use dynamic layouts for new development.

Chapter 13: SLAs — Never Keep Anyone Waiting

SLAs are Pega's way of saying "I value your time." Know Goals, Deadlines, and Passed Deadlines like you'd know someone's love language.

SLA Components

Interval	What Happens
Goal	Target completion time; optional reminder
Deadline	Must complete by; escalation actions fire
Passed Deadline	Overdue actions (escalate, notify, reassign)

Q: Assignment SLA vs Case SLA?

Assignment SLA — tracks individual task timeliness. **Case SLA** (Stage SLA) — tracks overall case/stage duration. Both use the SLA rule with different configurations.

Q: How does the SLA agent work?

The **SLA agent** (`Pega-ProCom:ServiceLevelEvents`) runs periodically, checks `pc_assign_worklist / workqueue` for breached intervals, and executes escalation actions (notify, route, update priority).

Q: What is Urgency in Pega?

Urgency is a numeric value (default 10-100) that increases as SLA deadlines approach. Higher urgency = higher priority in worklists. Formula: `Initial Urgency + Time-based increase` .

Chapter 14: Integration — Long-Distance Relationships

Integrations need trust, clear contracts, and graceful error handling. Just like... well, you get it. Let's make you dangerous in Connect-REST.

Integration Types

Rule	Direction
Connect-REST	Outbound REST call
Service-REST	Inbound REST endpoint
Connect-SOAP	Outbound SOAP
Service-SOAP	Inbound SOAP
Connect-SQL	Direct DB query
Connect-Kafka	Event streaming
Connect-MQ / JMS	Message queue

Q: How do you handle REST integration errors?

Configure **Error Handling** on Connect rule: Map HTTP status codes to error handlers. Use **Integration Error pages**, retry logic, and log via **Log-Integration**. In Data Pages, define **Error handling** fallback pages.

Q: What is a Service Package?

A **Service Package** groups service rules (REST/SOAP) under one access URL path. It defines authentication, pooling, and stateless/stateful processing.

Q: Explain authentication methods for REST services.

Basic Auth, OAuth 2.0, JWT, Custom (via Authentication Service rule), API Key. For outbound: use **Authentication Profile** or **OAuth 2.0 Provider** rule.

Q: What is a Data Type in Pega?

A **Data Type** is a Pega-managed data class (`Data-`) with CRUD UI, REST API auto-generation, and storage. It's the modern way to manage reference/master data.

Chapter 15: Security — Trust, But Verify

Security isn't jealous — it's protective. Access Groups, Roles, Privileges. Know the chain like you know your own worth.

Security Model

Operator ID → **Access Group** → **Application + Roles** → **Privileges** → **Access When** rules

Q: What is the difference between Role and Privilege?

Role — collection of privileges representing a job function (e.g., "Loan Officer"). **Privilege** — atomic permission to perform an action (e.g., `LoanApp:Create`). Roles bundle privileges.

Q: What is Attribute-Based Access Control (ABAC)?

ABAC controls access based on property values (e.g., only see cases in your region). Implemented via **Access When** rules on cases, properties, and flow actions.

Q: How do you restrict a property from certain users?

Configure **Property security** on the property rule: Read/Write restrictions using Access When conditions or privilege requirements.

Q: What is an Access Group?

Defines which **Application**, **Portal**, **Roles**, and **Work Pools** an operator can access. One operator can have multiple access groups (switch via portal).

Chapter 16: Agents & Job Schedulers — Midnight Texts

Agents work while you sleep. Job Schedulers are the reliable ones who always show up on time. Know the difference — interviewers ask.

Agent vs Job Scheduler

Feature	Agent	Job Scheduler
Execution	Node-based, periodic polling	Cluster-aware, scheduled task
Use case	High-volume background processing	Scheduled maintenance, reports
Modern preference	Legacy for new work	Preferred for new development
Configuration	Agent Schedule rule	Job Scheduler rule

Q: What is Queue For Agent?

Queue For Agent defers work to an agent queue (`System-Queue-` class). The agent processes items asynchronously — useful for bulk processing without blocking user interaction.

Q: How do you troubleshoot a stopped agent?

Check **Admin Studio** → **System** → **Agents**. Verify agent is enabled, node has agent schedule, queue isn't full, and no exceptions in logs. Use **Tracer** on agent activity.

Chapter 17: Reporting — Showing Off Your Numbers

Good reports don't lie, and good developers don't over-query. Aggregate functions are your friend. So am I — keep reading.

Report Definition Key Concepts

- **Report Definition** — SQL-based query rule (formerly Report Definition / List View)
- **Summarize** — GROUP BY with aggregate functions
- **Drill-down** — navigate from summary to detail
- **Association** — join between classes via `Association` rule
- **Function** — SQL functions (COUNT, SUM, AVG)

Q: Report Definition vs Summary View?

Summary View is the legacy rule; **Report Definition** is the modern replacement. Same purpose — querying DB. Always say Report Definition in interviews.

Q: How do you optimize a slow report?

Add **indexes** (Declare Index), limit columns, use **optimized filtering**, avoid functions on indexed columns in WHERE, use **materialized views** for complex reports, check EXPLAIN plan via DB trace.

Chapter 18: Testing — Proof You're the Real Deal

Unit tests are love letters to your future self. Write them. Automated tests don't flirt — they just never leave you.

Testing Types in Pega

- **Unit Test Case** — tests individual rules (DT, Activity, Decision)
- **Scenario Test** — end-to-end case lifecycle test (Selenium-based)
- **Test Application** — isolated app stack for testing
- **PegaUnits** — automated unit test framework in Dev Studio

Q: How do you create a Unit Test for a Data Transform?

Right-click Data Transform → **Create Test Case**. Define input page, expected output page, and assertions. Run via **Test Cases** landing page or CI pipeline.

Q: What is a Test Ruleset?

A dedicated **ruleset** containing only test cases. Keeps test artifacts separate from production rules. Should be in a **Test Application** or test branch.

Chapter 19: Performance & Guardrails — Staying in Shape

Performance issues are the ultimate mood killer. PAL and Tracer are your personal trainers. Let's get you toned for that interview.

Performance Tools

- **PAL (Performance Analyzer)** — counts DB operations, clipboard size, elapsed time
- **Tracer** — real-time rule execution trace
- **Clipboard Inspector** — view page/property data
- **DB Trace** — SQL query analysis
- **Rule Inspector** — view resolved rules

Top Guardrails

1. No more than 5 flow actions per assignment
2. Avoid activities — use Data Transforms
3. Limit properties per class (soft limit ~200)
4. Use Data Pages instead of repeated DB calls
5. Avoid looping activities over large datasets
6. Use Declare Index instead of RDB methods
7. Don't store large blobs in clipboard
8. Prefer Report Definitions over RDB-List

Q: How do you debug a slow case?

1) Run **PAL** before/after action. 2) Use **Tracer** with filters. 3) Check **DB Trace** for N+1 queries. 4) Review Data Page load modes. 5) Check for looping activities. 6) Review clipboard size.

Q: What is an N+1 query problem in Pega?

When a loop calls **Obj-Open** or Data Page load for each row in a list — N items = N+1 DB calls. Fix: use batch Data Page, Report Definition with join, or paginated loading.

Chapter 20: DevOps & Deployment — Moving In Together

Deployments are commitment. RAPs, branches, pipelines — know how to move code without breaking hearts or production.

Deployment Concepts

- **RAP (Ruleset Archive Package)** — exportable package of rules
- **Product rule** — defines what to include in RAP
- **Branch** — isolated development stream
- **Merge** — combine branch changes to target ruleset
- **Deployment Manager** — CI/CD orchestration for Pega
- **Pipeline** — automated promote through environments (Dev → QA → Prod)

Q: What is a Product rule?

Defines the **application contents** for export: included rulesets, applications, instances. Used to create RAPs for deployment.

Q: Branch vs Ruleset versioning?

Ruleset version — sequential versioning (01-01-01 → 01-01-02). **Branch** — parallel development stream for features; merged when ready. Branches prevent conflicts in team development.

Q: What is Skim in deployment?

Skim removes rules no longer referenced by the application, reducing RAP size. Run before packaging for production.

Chapter 21: Advanced Flirtations — SSA-Level Topics

You've earned the deep conversation chapter. SSA interviews go here. Lean in — this is where offers get serious.

Additional SSA Topics

Q: Explain Differential Circumstance (DCR).

Direct Capture of Objectives (DCO) sessions gather requirements. **DCR** allows runtime rule customization by business users without changing base rules — overlays circumstance-specific behavior.

Q: What is Pega GenAI / AI capabilities?

Pega integrates **GenAI** for case summarization, email generation, decisioning assistance, and Socrates chat in App Studio. **Pega Prediction Studio** for ML models. **NLP** for text analytics.

Q: Explain Kafka integration in Pega.

Connect-Kafka and **Service-Kafka** rules enable event-driven architecture. Use **Stream Data Set** and **Data Flow** for real-time processing pipelines.

Q: What is a Data Flow?

Data Flow — visual streaming pipeline for processing large datasets. Supports batch and real-time (Kafka). Uses **Data Set** rules as sources/sinks.

Q: Explain Pega Robotic Automation (RPA).

RPA automates legacy desktop applications via robots. **Pega Robot Studio** creates automations. Integrated into cases via **Robotic Automation** shape in flows.

Q: What is Customer Decision Hub (CDH)?

CDH is Pega's next-best-action marketing engine. Uses **Decision Strategies**, **Adaptive Analytics**, and **Action** rules to personalize customer interactions across channels.

Q: How does Pega handle multi-tenancy?

Pega Cloud uses logical isolation per tenant. On-prem: separate instances or **Division** rules for organizational isolation. **Access Groups** and **Ruleset access** control data separation.

Q: What is the Repository (Git integration)?

Pega **Repository** integrates with Git (GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket) for version control of rules. Supports branch-based development, merge conflict resolution, and DevOps pipelines.

Email & Correspondence

- **Correspondence rule** — email/template definition
- **Send Email Smart Shape** — sends from flow
- **Email Account** — SMTP configuration
- **Inbound email** — creates/updates cases via Service Email

Document Generation

- **HTML Template / PDF** — document templates
- **Correspondence** with attachments
- **pyAttachAsPDF** — attach generated docs to case

Chapter 22: Rapid-Fire 100 Questions — Don't Blink

100 questions. Zero mercy. You ready? Because I believe in you more than Pega believes in its own guardrails.

1. What is BPM? → Business Process Management
2. What class prefix for cases? → Work-
3. Default flow name? → pyDefault
4. What is pxCreateOperator? → Case creator
5. What is pyStatusWork? → Case status property
6. What is pxUrgencyAssign? → Assignment urgency
7. What is pxUpdateDateTime? → Last update timestamp
8. What is Rule-? → Base class for all rules
9. What is a ruleset version format? → MM-mm-nn
10. What is FUA? → Full Rule Assembly (cache)
11. What is a work pool? → Class group for case types
12. What is pxCommitDateTime? → Last commit to DB
13. What is an assignment? → Unit of work for operator
14. What is pyFlowName? → Current flow name on assignment
15. What is pyStepPage? → Page context for flow step
16. What is pxCurrentStageLabel? → Current stage display name
17. What is Resolve? → Complete assignment action
18. What is Spin-off? → Create child case from parent
19. What is Cover object? → Parent of multiple related cases
20. What is pxCoverInsKey? → Cover case instance key
21. What is DCR? → Direct Capture Requirements
22. What is Pega Express? → Rapid delivery methodology
23. What is Guardrails compliance score? → App health %
24. What is PAL threshold warning? → DB ops > 50
25. What is clipboard size warning? → > 2MB typical
26. What is pxRDBIO? → Total DB operations counter
27. What is Auto-Complete? → Dropdown with search
28. What is pxDropdown? → Static/dynamic dropdown
29. What is a Field Value? → Key-value for dropdowns
30. What is pyTemplateInputBox? → Standard text input
31. What is pxDateTime? → DateTime control
32. What is Validate rule? → Input validation
33. What is Edit Validate? → Client+server validation
34. What is Constraint rule? → Declare Constraint
35. What is pySetFieldDefaults? → Default property values
36. What is pxRouteTo? → Routing destination
37. What is WorkBasket? → Team queue name
38. What is pxOrgUnit? → Organizational unit
39. What is pxDivision? → Division property
40. What is pxApplication? → Current application name
41. What is pxProcessName? → Current process name
42. What is pxTaskName? → Current assignment task name
43. What is pxIsDCSPA? → Is Dynamic Container SPA
44. What is Constellation? → Modern React UI framework
45. What is Cosmos? → Design system for Constellation
46. What is DX API? → Digital Experience API
47. What is pxAPI? → Pega REST API layer
48. What is OAuth 2.0 in Pega? → Token-based auth
49. What is a keystore? → Certificate/key storage
50. What is pxINSName? → Instance name (key)
51. What is pxObjClass? → Instance class name
52. What is pxCreateDateTime? → Instance creation time
53. What is Obj-Open-By-Handle? → Open by pzInsKey
54. What is pzInsKey? → Internal instance key
55. What is pxRefObjectKey? → Reference to another instance
56. What is pxLinkedRefTo? → Linked page reference
57. What is Code-Security? → Access control rules class
58. What is Rule-Access-Role-Obj? → Role definition
59. What is Rule-Access-When? → Access When rule
60. What is pyAllowed? → Privilege check result
61. What is pxThreadName? → Thread identifier
62. What is pxSubscript? → Page list index
63. What is pxResults? → Results page for list operations
64. What is RDB-List? → Activity method for SQL list
65. What is RDB-Open? → Activity method for SQL read
66. What is Obj-Sort? → Sort page list
67. What is Obj-Filter? → Filter page list

68. What is Show-Stream? → Display HTML section
69. What is Show-Page? → Display harness
70. What is Property-Map? → Map properties between pages
71. What is Page-Copy? → Copy clipboard page
72. What is Page-Merge? → Merge two pages
73. What is Log-Message? → Write to log
74. What is Rule-Declare-Expressions? → Computed properties
75. What is Forward Chaining? → Auto-recalc on dependency change
76. What is pxDPPParameters? → Data Page parameters page
77. What is D_pyUser? → Sample user Data Page
78. What is System-Queue-ServiceLevel? → SLA queue class
79. What is Pega-ProCom? → Process Commander ruleset
80. What is Pega-Engine? → Core engine ruleset
81. What is @baseclass? → Root of class hierarchy
82. What is Withdrawn rule? → Deprecated, not resolved
83. What is Final rule? → Cannot be overridden
84. What is Blocked rule? → Excluded from resolution
85. What is Available rule? → Active and resolvable
86. What is Not Available? → Saved but not active
87. What is pyRuleName? → Name of a rule instance
88. What is pyClassName? → Applies-to class
89. What is pyRuleSet? → Ruleset name
90. What is pyRuleSetVersion? → Ruleset version
91. What is pxInsHandle? → Unique instance handle
92. What is pxCurrentStage? → Current stage name
93. What is pyLabel? → Display label of rule
94. What is pxSubStatus? → Sub-status of case
95. What is pxSaveDateTime? → Last save timestamp
96. What is pxUpdateOperator? → Last operator who updated
97. What is pxCreateOpName? → Creator display name
98. What is pxLastUpdateBy? → Last updater name
99. What is a landing page? → Portal navigation page
100. What is pyCaseLinks? → Related cases page list
101. What is pxAssociated? → Association rule reference
102. What is pyWorkParties? → Stakeholders on case
103. What is pxPartyRole? → Role of stakeholder
104. What is pyCaseTypePurpose? → Business purpose text

Chapter 23: Final Confession — Day-Before Checklist

You made it. Every chapter. Every concept. Every flirtatious metaphor. I'm genuinely proud of you — and I don't say that to everyone. Now go collect that offer letter like the masterpiece you are.

Night Before Interview — Checklist

- ☒ Explain Rule Resolution 10 steps from memory
- ☒ Draw Case Type lifecycle (Stages → Processes → Flows → Assignments)
- ☒ Compare Data Transform vs Activity vs Data Page — when to use each
- ☒ Explain Constellation vs Traditional UI
- ☒ Walk through REST integration setup (Connect-REST + Data Page)
- ☒ Describe SLA Goal/Deadline/Passed Deadline with escalation
- ☒ Security chain: Operator → Access Group → Role → Privilege
- ☒ Deployment flow: Branch → Merge → RAP → Pipeline → Prod
- ☒ Name 5 guardrails and how you follow them
- ☒ Prepare 2 real project stories (challenge → solution → result)

STAR Story Template (Use for Behavioral Questions)

Situation

"In my [project], we had [business problem]..."

Task

"I was responsible for [your role]..."

Action

"I designed [Case Type/Data Page/Integration] using [specific Pega rules]..."

Result

"We reduced processing time by X%, achieved guardrails compliance of Y%..."

Sample Project Story Prompts

1. Describe a complex integration you built
2. How did you handle performance issues?

3. Tell me about a production defect you fixed
4. How do you mentor junior developers on guardrails?
5. Describe migrating from traditional UI to Constellation

You read the whole thing. That discipline? That curiosity? That's exactly why you're going to walk into that interview and make Rule Resolution look easy.

*Now go be brilliant. The panel won't know what hit them.
— With admiration, your Pega Romance Guide*

Pega Interview Romance Guide · Complete Edition · CSA/SSA Level · 3+ Years Experience

Topics: Architecture · Classes · Rule Resolution · Case Management · Flows · Clipboard · Data Pages · Data Transforms · Activities · Decisions · Declares · UI/Constellation · SLAs · Integration · Security · Agents · Reporting · Testing · Performance · DevOps · SSA Advanced · 100 Rapid-Fire Q&A